

COVER TO COVER

THE BOOK OF RUTH

Teaching Notes

A Prophetic Journey of Redemption, Covenant, and the Kinsman Redeemer

THE BOOK OF RUTH IS READ DURING THE FEAST OF PENTECOST

INTRODUCTION

The Gospel Hidden in a Love Story

The Book of Ruth is far more than a beautiful romance story. Hidden inside these four short chapters is one of the clearest prophetic pictures of redemption in all of Scripture.

This is a 3,000-year-old story, yet it speaks directly to:

- redemption,
- covenant,
- grace,
- restoration,
- and the Gospel of Jesus Christ.

Ruth is one of only two books in Scripture named after a woman — Ruth and Esther. Yet Ruth is unique because she is a Gentile woman who becomes part of the Messianic lineage of Jesus Christ.

Matthew 1 includes four women in the genealogy:

- Tamar
- Rahab
- Ruth
- Bathsheba

All four carried stories of scandal, brokenness, exclusion, or Gentile background. God intentionally built the Messianic line through imperfect people to reveal that redemption is greater than shame.

The central message of Ruth is the **Kinsman Redeemer**.

Boaz is a prophetic picture of Jesus Christ.

Under Jewish law:

- only a relative could redeem,
- only someone qualified could pay,
- and redemption had to occur legally before witnesses.

Jesus became flesh so He could become our “Boaz” — our Kinsman Redeemer.

CHAPTER 1 — LEAVING THE HOUSE OF BREAD

Ruth 1:1–5

“Now it came to pass in the days when the judges ruled, that there was a famine in the land...”
— Ruth 1:1

The story takes place during the dark days of the Judges, likely during the Moabite oppression before Gideon’s victory.

The book opens with famine.

Elimelech takes Naomi and their two sons from Bethlehem into Moab.

Bethlehem means:

“House of Bread.”

There is deep prophetic symbolism here.

They left the House of Bread during famine.

How often do people walk away from the very place God intends to sustain them because circumstances become difficult?

The text says they went to “sojourn” in Moab — meaning they intended to return.

But compromise rarely stays temporary.

EPHRATHITES — PEOPLE OF BETHLEHEM

Ruth 1:2

The family is called Ephrathites.

Ephrath was an ancient name for Bethlehem (Micah 5:2), the same Bethlehem where Jesus would later be born.

Even at the beginning of Ruth, God is already quietly pointing toward the Messiah.

MOAB — A LAND OUTSIDE COVENANT

Moab was historically associated with idolatry and the worship of Chemosh (kimosh) (2 Kings 23:13).

Spiritually, Moab represents:

- compromise,
- fleshly survival,
- and living outside covenant provision.

The family leaves covenant land seeking survival, but instead encounters death.

Sometimes we think changing locations will solve our problems.

But:

“Wherever you go, you bring yourself with you.”

The same fears and struggles often follow us because the issue is not geographical — it is spiritual.

THE PROPHETIC MEANING OF THE NAMES

The names in Ruth preach a sermon by themselves.

Elimelech — “My God is King”

His name declares trust in God’s rule, yet his actions reveal fear rather than faith.

His life becomes a picture of believers who confess God’s authority with their mouth but step outside covenant when pressure comes.

Naomi — “Pleasant”

Ruth 1:20

After tragedy Naomi says:

“Call me not Naomi... call me Mara.”

“Mara” means:

“Bitter.”

Naomi becomes a prophetic picture of Israel:

- once pleasant in covenant,
- later bitter through suffering,
- yet eventually restored through redemption.

Pain distorted her identity temporarily, but redemption would restore what bitterness tried to rename.

Mahlon — “Sickness”

Man of sickness or man of infirmity...it comes from a verb that means “fatally pierced.”

Chilion — “Wasting Away”

Their names prophetically describe the condition of the household:

- weakness,
- decay,
- deterioration,
- death.

The family progressively moved from:

- famine,
- to compromise,
- to weakness,
- to death.

Yet even in weakness, God was already preparing redemption.

Some teachers note that Ruth was first married to Mahlon before Boaz — humanity first joined to weakness before being joined to the Redeemer.

Orpah — “Turning Back”

Ruth 1:14

Orpah kissed Naomi and returned to Moab.

Her name means:

- neck,
- turning back,
- back of the neck.

Orpah represents people who come close to covenant but turn back when sacrifice becomes costly.

Ruth — “Faithful Companion”

Ruth 1:16

Ruth means:

- companion,
- faithful friend,
- beloved.

Her name perfectly reflects her character:

- loyal,
- covenant-minded,
- devoted.

She becomes one of Scripture's clearest pictures of the Gentile bride brought near through redemption.

RUTH VS ORPAH — TWO SPIRITUAL PATHS

Ruth 1:14

In 2 Samuel 21:15–22, Scripture mentions four Philistine giants from Gath who fought against David and his mighty men.

These warriors are called:

“the children of Harafah” (hair uh fah) (or Rapha)

The Babylonian Talmud (Sotah 42b) makes a remarkable connection:

The rabbis identify **Harafah** (הרפה) with **Orpah** (ערפה).

They note that the names are very similar in Hebrew and teach that Harafah and Orpah are the same woman. ([The Torah](#))....only one consonant is different in the spelling of their name.

Because of this identification, rabbinic tradition teaches:

- Goliath and his four brothers... were sons of Orpah

This links:

- Ruth's family line → David
- Orpah's family line → Goliath and the Philistine giants

The rabbis present this as two family lines moving in opposite spiritual directions.

Source:

- Babylonian Talmud, Sotah 42b
- [The Defamation of Orpah – TheTorah.com](#)

“And Orpah kissed her mother in law; but Ruth clave unto her.”

Rabbinic teaching builds heavily on this contrast.

The rabbis taught:

- Orpah kissed,
- Ruth clung.

One showed affection.

The other showed covenant commitment.

The rabbis summarized it powerfully:

“Let the sons of the one who kissed fall into the hands of the sons of the one who clung.”

Ishbi-Benob and David

And this is exactly what happened...the sons of Orpah were killed/fell into the hands/ by David and his mighty men... who was Ruth's (great grandson) son

The warriors listed in 2 Samuel 21 include:

- Ishbi-benob (also spelled Isbi-benob)
- Saph
- The brother of Goliath
- A giant with six fingers and six toes

The text concludes:

“These four were born to Harafah in Gath, and fell by the hand of David and by the hand of his servants.”

— 2 Samuel 21:22

Rabbinic interpretation says these “sons of Harafah” are the sons of Orpah. ([The Torah](#))

The rabbis especially expand the story of Ishbi-benob in 2 Samuel 21:16.

In Midrash and Talmudic tradition:

- Ishbi-benob sought to kill David
- The battle became symbolic revenge from Orpah's house against Ruth's house
- Some traditions even say Orpah herself was involved and died during the conflict
- So...in reality this became a family feud

This is part of a broader rabbinic theme:

the descendants of Ruth and Orpah are continuing the choice their mothers made in Ruth 1.

Source:

- Babylonian Talmud, Sanhedrin 95a–b
- Discussed in: [Jewish Women's Archive – Orpah: Midrash and Aggadah](#)

TEN YEARS IN MOAB

Ruth 1:4

The family remains in Moab “about ten years.”

Nine often symbolizes judgment.

Ten symbolizes testimony.

The family passed through a season of judgment, but God was preparing testimony.

By the end of ten years:

- Elimelech is dead,
- Mahlon is dead,
- Chilion is dead.

Only three widows remain.

Naomi is left with nothing but a remnant.

Yet throughout Scripture, God works through remnants.

RUTH'S COVENANT DECLARATION

Ruth 1:16–17

“Thy people shall be my people, and thy God my God.”

This is not emotional sentiment.

This is covenant language.

Ruth completely turns from:

- Moab,
- false gods,
- old identity,
- and old inheritance.

She chooses covenant relationship.

This becomes a prophetic preview of the Gentile Church being brought near through Christ.

CHAPTER 2 — THE FIELD OF BOAZ

Ruth 2:1–23

The story shifts from famine to harvest.

The timing matters.

The events unfold during barley harvest — the season of firstfruits.

In Scripture, firstfruits points toward:

- resurrection,
- promise,
- harvest,
- and new beginnings.

God is already hinting that redemption is beginning.

BOAZ — A PICTURE OF CHRIST

Ruth 2:1

Boaz is introduced as:

“a mighty man of wealth.”

His name means:

“In Him is strength.”

Immediately we begin seeing a prophetic picture:

- Boaz represents Christ,
- Ruth represents the Gentile bride,
- Naomi represents Israel.

“IT HAPPENED”

Ruth 2:3

Ruth “happens” into the field of Boaz.

There are no accidents in redemption.

Providence often looks accidental until you see the full story.

HANDFULS ON PURPOSE

Ruth 2:14–16

Boaz gives Ruth:

- protection,
- provision,
- privilege.

Protection

“The men will not touch you.”

Provision

Fresh water.

Unlimited access to the field...without conditions

Handfuls on purpose.

These were huge gifts without condition...

This is grace.

Ruth is surviving because of intentional favor from the redeemer.

Long before Paul taught grace in Ephesians, Ruth was already living in it.

PRIVILEGE

He called her daughter... Which automatically placed her under the protection of his house.

LET’S connect Ruth’s experience with the spiritual blessings Paul describes in Epistle to the Ephesians 1:3–14:

In Book of Ruth, Boaz becomes a picture of the Redeemer, and Ruth becomes a living example of grace before grace was ever fully explained in the New Testament.

THE BOOK OF RUTH IS **EXPLAINING** GRACE TO US RIGHT HERE!....What GRACE looks like: protection provision & privilege.

What Ruth received from Boaz mirrors what believers receive in Christ.

Boaz Gave Ruth Protection

“The men will not touch you.”

Boaz placed Ruth under his covering and guaranteed her safety. She no longer had to live vulnerable and exposed.

In Ephesians 1, we see that in Christ we have been:

- chosen,
- adopted,
- sealed,
- and secured.

Paul says we were “sealed with the Holy Spirit of promise” (Ephesians 1:13). That seal speaks of protection, ownership, and security.

Just as Ruth was protected in Boaz’s field, we are protected in Christ. We are no longer spiritual outsiders trying to survive on our own.

Boaz Gave Ruth Provision

- Fresh water
- Unlimited access to the field, without condition
- Handfuls on purpose

These gifts were not **earned**.

Ruth did not **qualify** for them by status or performance. Boaz intentionally blessed her because of his kindness.

That is grace.

Paul begins Ephesians by saying:

“Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who has blessed us with every spiritual blessing in heavenly places in Christ.”

Like Ruth, we receive:

- provision we did not earn,
- access we did not deserve,
- and favor that was intentionally prepared for us.

“Handfuls on purpose” sounds a lot like:

- redemption,
- forgiveness,
- inheritance,
- and abounding grace.

God does not merely give enough to survive.
He gives abundantly and intentionally.

Ruth survived because of the **intentional favor** of the redeemer.
We thrive because of the intentional grace of Christ.

Grace is His demonstrated delight!

Boaz Gave Ruth Privilege

He called her “daughter.”

That one word changed Ruth’s position.

She was **no longer just a foreigner** gleaning in a field.
Being called **“daughter” placed her under the protection and privilege of Boaz’s house.**

Ephesians says we have been:

- **predestined unto adoption,**
- **accepted in the Beloved,**
- **and made heirs in Christ.**

We are not just tolerated servants in God’s field.
We are sons and daughters in His house.

Ruth received a new identity through relationship with the redeemer.
Believers receive a new identity through Jesus.

Big Theme

Long before Paul taught grace in Ephesians, Ruth was already living in it.

Boaz became a prophetic picture of Jesus:

- **protection without fear,**
- **provision without measure,**
- **privilege without earning it.**

Everything Ruth received came because a redeemer chose to show kindness.

Everything we have in Christ comes because of grace.

THE COVENANT MEAL

Ruth 2:14

Then he ends their conversation with a meal.

Boaz shares bread with Ruth.

Meals had greater significance in ancient cultures than our meals today. Meals were commonly used to seal, solemn agreements or covenants. So this represented a covenant meal.

Meals in ancient Israel often sealed covenant agreements.

This meal symbolized:

- acceptance,
- provision,
- relationship,
- covenant fellowship.

ESHET CHAYIL — WOMAN OF VALOR

Ruth 3:10–11

Boaz calls Ruth:

“Eshet Chayil.”

This is the same phrase found in Proverbs 31.

“Who can find a “virtuous woman”...

What is remarkable is that Ruth receives this title:

- BEFORE motherhood,
- while poor,
- A destitute widowed,
- While she is a stranger/alien/ foreigner in Israel.

Ruth forsook her birthplace and her family to join with the God of Israel and His people...this caught Boaz attention.

It was Boaz that declared Ruth was an “Eshet Chayil”.

ESHET CHAYIL — HOW HE SEES US

Ruth, Boaz, and the Identity Jesus Speaks Over Broken People

Text

Ruth 3:10–11 — “Then he said, ‘Blessed are you of the Lord, my daughter! For you have shown more kindness at the end than at the beginning, in that you did not go after young men, whether poor or rich. And now, my daughter, do not fear. I will do for you all that you request, for all the people of my town know that you are a virtuous woman.’”

The Hebrew phrase Boaz uses for Ruth is:

ESHET CHAYIL

A woman of valor.

A woman of noble character.

A woman of virtue.
A woman of strength.

This is the same phrase used in Proverbs 31:

“Who can find a virtuous woman...” (Proverbs 31:10)

But what makes this so powerful...
Ruth did not look like what Boaz called her.

She was:

- A widow.
- Poor.
- A foreigner.
- An outsider.
- Childless.
- Broken by loss.
- Living in survival mode.
- Gathering leftovers from fields.

And yet Boaz looked at her and said:

“You are Eshet Chayil.”

Not after she became wealthy.
Not after she became a mother.
Not after society accepted her.
Not after she had everything together.

Before all of that...
he called out what heaven already saw.

BEFORE CHRIST — WHO WERE WE?

The truth is...
all of us were Ruth.

We were outsiders.

Ephesians 2:12 — “At that time you were without Christ, being aliens from the commonwealth of Israel and strangers from the covenants of promise, having no hope and without God in the

world.”

We were spiritually poor.

Matthew 5:3 — “Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.”

We were broken by loss.

Isaiah 53:6 — “All we like sheep have gone astray...”

We were carrying shame.

Romans 3:23 — “For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God.”

We were gathering scraps emotionally.

Trying to survive.

Trying to make it another day.

Trying to find worth from broken places.

Trying to silence pain.

Trying to belong.

Some people came into church feeling exactly like Ruth.

Not feeling chosen.

Not feeling qualified.

Not feeling pure enough.

Not feeling valuable enough.

But then Jesus stepped into our field.

BOAZ IS A PICTURE OF CHRIST

Throughout scripture, Boaz is a type and shadow of Jesus:

- Boaz was a redeemer.
- Jesus is our Redeemer.

Job 19:25 — “For I know that my Redeemer lives...”

- Boaz noticed Ruth when others overlooked her.
- Jesus sees people others ignore.

Luke 19:10 — “For the Son of Man has come to seek and to save that which was lost.”

- Boaz spoke identity over Ruth.

- Jesus speaks identity over us.
- Boaz covered Ruth.
- Jesus covers us with righteousness.

Isaiah 61:10 — “He has clothed me with the garments of salvation, He has covered me with the robe of righteousness...”

Boaz did not define Ruth by her condition.
He defined her by her covenant.

And God does the same with us.

HOW DID RUTH BECOME “ESHET CHAYIL”?

Ruth was not called virtuous because her past was perfect.

She became identified by:

- surrender,
- loyalty,
- covenant,
- and pursuit of God.

1. SHE LEFT HER OLD LIFE

Ruth 1:16 — “Your people shall be my people, and your God, my God.”

Ruth walked away from Moab.
Moab represented idolatry.
Comfort.
Familiarity.
Her past identity.

Before she was ever called “Eshet Chayil,”
she made a decision:
“I will follow God.”

That is salvation.

You become new when you leave the old life behind.

2 Corinthians 5:17 — “Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation...”

She crossed over from outsider to covenant.

And the moment you came to Jesus,
You are no longer identified by you by where you came from.

2. BOAZ SAW WHAT OTHERS COULD NOT SEE

Others saw:

- a foreigner.
- a widow.
- a poor woman in a field.

Boaz saw:

- loyalty.
- faithfulness.
- humility.
- hunger.
- covenant.
- sacrifice.

This is exactly how Jesus sees us.

People may see your history.
Jesus sees your destiny.

People may see addiction.
Jesus sees deliverance.

People may see failure.
Jesus sees redemption.

People may see weakness.
Jesus sees someone His grace can transform.

1 Samuel 16:7 — “Man looks at the outward appearance, but the Lord looks at the heart.”

Boaz saw Ruth through covenant eyes.
Jesus sees us through redemption eyes.

3. HER IDENTITY CHANGED BEFORE HER CIRCUMSTANCES DID

This is where people miss the power of the story.

Ruth was called “Eshet Chayil” before:

- the marriage.
- the blessing.
- the breakthrough.
- the child.
- the restoration.

Her identity changed before her situation changed.

That is the Gospel.

God calls things that are not as though they were.

Romans 4:17 — “God...calls those things which do not exist as though they did.”

Jesus calls Simon “Peter” while he is still unstable.

Jesus calls Gideon a mighty man while he is hiding.

Jesus calls us righteous while we are still learning to walk out freedom.

Because heaven speaks to who you are becoming.

JESUS SPEAKS OVER US WHAT BOAZ SPOKE OVER RUTH

The enemy says:

- You are disqualified.
- You are too broken.
- You are too dirty.

- You are too far gone.
- You will always be defined by your past.

But Jesus says:

“I see who you really are.”

1 Peter 2:9 — “But you are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, His own special people...”

Notice:

He calls us chosen before we feel chosen.

Holy before we feel holy.

Royal before we feel worthy.

This is grace.

Grace does not ignore what we were.

Grace transforms what we were.

THE POWER OF BEING SEEN

Ruth probably walked into that field feeling invisible.

But one moment with Boaz changed everything.

Can you imagine the emotion of hearing someone call greatness out of you when life has only called you broken?

Can you imagine hearing:

“You are valuable”

when grief told you that you were forgotten?

Can you imagine hearing:

“You are virtuous”

when shame told you that you were ruined?

This is what Jesus does.

He speaks heaven’s identity over earth’s pain.

He calls sons out of orphans.

He calls purpose out of pain.

He calls beauty out of ashes.

Isaiah 61:3 — “To give them beauty for ashes...”

THE CROSS IS WHERE OUR NAME CHANGED

How did we become righteous?

How did we become accepted?

How did we become “Eshet Chayil” spiritually speaking?

Because Jesus exchanged places with us.

2 Corinthians 5:21 — “For He made Him who knew no sin to be sin for us, that we might become the righteousness of God in Him.”

At the cross:

- our shame became His.
- our sin became His.
- our rejection became His.
- our brokenness became His.

And His righteousness became ours.

He covered us.

Just like Boaz covered Ruth.

PREACHING MOMENT

Somebody in this room has been defining themselves by:

- the divorce,
- the addiction,
- the failure,
- the rejection,
- the abuse,
- the betrayal,
- the mistake,
- the season of loss.

But heaven is not speaking your past over you.

Heaven is speaking covenant over you.

You may feel like Ruth:

- overlooked,
- empty,
- broken,
- surviving on leftovers.

But Jesus walks into your field today and says:

“I know who you are.”

“You are chosen.”

“You are redeemed.”

“You are loved.”

“You are Mine.”

The world may call you foreign,
but the Father calls you family.

The world may call you ruined,
but the Father calls you redeemed.

The world may call you forgotten,
but heaven calls you “Eshet Chayil.”

CLOSING

Ruth did not earn her identity through performance.
She stepped into covenant.

And covenant changed her name.

The same is true for us.

We were once:

- strangers,
- outsiders,
- spiritually poor,
- hopeless.

But through Jesus:

- we became sons and daughters,
- righteous,
- accepted,
- redeemed,
- and called by a new name.

Isaiah 62:2 — “You shall be called by a new name, which the mouth of the Lord will name.”

Boaz spoke prophetically over Ruth.
Jesus speaks eternally over us.

And when Jesus speaks over your life,
He does not merely describe who you were.
He reveals who grace is transforming you into.

CHAPTER 3 — THE THRESHING FLOOR

Ruth 3:1–18

Naomi instructs Ruth:

- wash,
- anoint yourself,
- put on your garments.

These symbolize:

- sanctification,
- the Holy Spirit,
- robes of righteousness.

THE THRESHING FLOOR

Threshing floors symbolize:

- separation,
- purification,
- judgment.

Wheat is separated from chaff there.

In biblical times, wheat and chaff were separated at the threshing floor — a place of crushing, shaking, and separation.

The wheat was precious because it carried life, nourishment, and future harvest, but the chaff was only the dry outer shell — light, empty, and worthless once the real grain was revealed. After the harvest, the farmer would toss everything into the air, and the wind would carry the chaff away while the wheat fell back to the ground because it had substance. Scripture uses this powerful imagery to reveal the difference between what is genuine and what is superficial. Psalm 1 says the wicked are like chaff blown away by the wind, while true righteousness remains rooted and fruitful. John the Baptist declared that Jesus would thoroughly purge His floor, gathering the wheat into His barn while the chaff would be burned. God is not interested in empty religion, outward appearance, or surface-level devotion. He is after real fruit, real faith, and hearts that remain when the winds begin to blow.

That is why the threshing floor in the Book of Ruth is so powerful. Ruth's greatest moment of redemption did not happen in comfort — it happened at the threshing floor.

It was the place where separation occurred, where what was valuable was revealed, and where covenant destiny was uncovered.

Before God can bring promotion, harvest, and restoration, He often allows a threshing process to remove pride, fear, compromise, and everything fleshly that cannot remain.

The shaking is never meant to destroy the wheat; it is meant to expose it.

Sometimes God allows pressure because there is something valuable hidden beneath the outer layers that can only emerge through surrender and refinement. The chaff may blow away, but the wheat remains because it has weight, substance, and life inside it. And just like Ruth, when we surrender ourselves completely at the feet of the Redeemer, the threshing floor becomes the very place where God transforms bitterness into blessing, emptiness into fullness, and brokenness into redemption.

Ruth approaches Boaz in humility and surrender.

She uncovers his feet — an ancient marriage proposal connected to covenant imagery (Ezekiel 16:8).

By uncovering Boaz's feet, Ruth is inviting a marriage proposal! When Boaz wakes up and finds Ruth there, Ruth politely says I'm willing to have you as my redeemer, if you're willing to fulfill the law on my behalf.

Verse 12 and 13 Boaz tells Ruth yes it is true that I am a family, redeemer, but there is a redeemer closer than I... Stay here tonight, and in the morning if he wants to redeem you, that's good. Let him redeem you. But if he doesn't want to redeem you as the Lord lives, I will.

Boaz was much older than Ruth. He hadn't pursued marriage because he was older, and there was another next of kin.

She is essentially asking:

"Will you redeem me?"

Boaz responds immediately:

"I will do all that you ask."

That is the heart of the Redeemer.

THE CLOSER KINSMAN

Ruth 3:12–13

Boaz reveals another redeemer is legally closer.

This nearer kinsman becomes a picture of the Law.

The Law:

- can expose need,
- can identify inheritance,
- but cannot redeem the bride.

Grace fulfills what the Law cannot.

SIX MEASURES OF BARLEY

Ruth 3:15

Boaz gives Ruth six measures of barley so Naomi will not remain empty.

Verse 14 through 16... Boaz shoveled six measures of barley into her shawl... Then she goes back to Naomi and tells her what he did because he said don't go back to your mother-in-law empty-handed.

Jewish tradition says the six measures of barley were a sign of the six religious men who would descend from her...

Jewish tradition from the Talmud, teaches that these six measures symbolized six great righteous descendants who would come from Ruth's lineage

1. David
2. Daniel
3. Hananiah... Shadrach
4. Mishael... Meshach
5. Azariah... Abednego
6. Jesus Christ

The six measures of barley becomes a prophetic promise: emptiness will become fullness.

Interesting Facts About Each Man

1. King David

- Ruth's great-grandson and the greatest king of Israel.
- A shepherd boy who defeated Goliath with a sling and a stone (1 Samuel 17).
- Wrote many of the Psalms.
- God made a covenant with David that his throne would endure forever (2 Samuel 7).
- The Messiah was prophesied to come through David's lineage.
- Despite major failures, David was called "a man after God's own heart."

Fascinating Connection

David's life reflects Ruth's redemption story:

- Ruth was a foreigner brought near.
- David later united Israel.
- The Messiah would eventually come through this redeemed bloodline.

2. Daniel

- Taken captive into Babylon as a young man.

- Refused to compromise his faith even in a pagan culture.
- Interpreted dreams for kings.
- Survived the lions' den because of God's protection.
- Received prophetic visions about future kingdoms and the coming Messiah.

Interesting Fact

Daniel's integrity was so strong that even his enemies could find no fault in him except his devotion to God (Daniel 6:4–5).

Prophetic Importance

Daniel's visions include one of the clearest Old Testament prophecies of the coming Messiah and His kingdom.

3. Hananiah

- One of Daniel's three companions in Babylon.
- Given the Babylonian name Shadrach.
- Refused to bow to Nebuchadnezzar's golden image.
- Thrown into the fiery furnace for his faith.

Powerful Detail

When the king looked into the furnace, he saw a fourth man walking with them in the fire (Daniel 3). Many believers see this as a pre-incarnate appearance of Christ.

Meaning of His Hebrew Name

Hananiah means "Yahweh is gracious."

4. Mishael

- Another of Daniel's faithful companions.
- Babylonian name: Meshach.
- Chose obedience to God over self-preservation.
- Survived the fiery furnace untouched.

Amazing Miracle

Not even the smell of smoke was on their clothes after the fire (Daniel 3:27).

Meaning of His Name

Mishael means “Who is what God is?” — a declaration of God’s uniqueness.

5. Azariah

- Third companion of Daniel.
- Babylonian name: Abednego.
- Refused idol worship alongside Hananiah and Mishael.
- Experienced supernatural deliverance from the furnace.

Meaning of His Name

Azariah means “Yahweh has helped.”

Important Spiritual Theme

These three young men demonstrated that true worship belongs only to God, even under pressure from government and culture.

6. Jesus Christ

- The ultimate fulfillment of Ruth’s redeemed family line.
- Born in Bethlehem — the same town central to Ruth’s story.
- Called the “Son of David.”
- Acts as the true Kinsman-Redeemer, just as Boaz redeemed Ruth.

Incredible Parallel Between Boaz and Jesus

Boaz	Jesus
Redeemed Ruth	Redeems humanity
Near kinsman	Became one of us
Paid the price	Paid the price at the cross
Gave rest and provision	Gives salvation and eternal rest

Jewish tradition saw the six measures of barley as more than generosity:

- A prophetic sign.
- A promise of future redemption.
- A preview of God’s unfolding plan through Ruth’s lineage. ([Precept Austin](#))

The barley pointed forward to:

- Kingship through David,
- Faithfulness in exile through Daniel and his companions,
- And ultimately the Messiah.

Ruth's story begins with loss and emptiness, but the six measures prophetically pointed toward fullness, redemption, and the coming King.

Verse 12 & 15... May you be powerful in Ephrathah and your name well known in Bethlehem..."Qara"...called up or declared...so the name of Boaz will be declared in Bethlehem...Perez became the leading family within the Tribe of Judah. Now the crowd declared that BOAZ carried the SEED promise in his family line having descended from Perez. May his name become well-known in Israel... this is a Messianic prophecy.

CHAPTER 4 — THE LEGAL REDEMPTION

Ruth 4:1–12

Boaz goes publicly to the gate before ten elders.

This is a legal transaction.

Redemption is not merely emotional.
It is judicial.

THE SHOE COVENANT

Ruth 4:7–8

The nearer kinsman removes his sandal and gives it to Boaz.

This symbolized:

- transfer of rights,
- surrender of inheritance,
- legal ownership.

Prophetically:
Adam could not redeem humanity.

So Christ stepped into our place.

We cannot redeem ourselves.

Jesus fulfilled what fallen humanity could never accomplish.

THE TEN WITNESSES

Some rabbinic traditions say Boaz and the elders at the city gate were not merely discussing land redemption — they were also legally settling whether Ruth could lawfully enter covenant community and marry into Israel.

That makes the scene at the gate even more powerful.

The redemption of Ruth becomes a public legal declaration that grace has made a way for someone formerly excluded.

Why ten elders?

Because redemption had to satisfy the Law.

The Law stands as witness against humanity.

But Jesus fulfilled every demand of righteousness through His sinless life.

Like Boaz before the elders, Christ stood under the scrutiny of the Law and satisfied every requirement.

BOAZ PROPHETIC DESTINY CALLED OUT:

VS 4:11...

Verses 12 and 15 carry a powerful prophetic declaration over Boaz and his future lineage. The people begin speaking blessing over him, saying:

“May you prosper in Ephrathah and be famous in Bethlehem.”

The Hebrew word connected to this idea is “**Qara**,” meaning:

- to call forth,
- to proclaim,
- to declare openly.

In other words, the crowd was prophetically calling the name of Boaz into destiny. They were declaring that his name would rise in influence and honor throughout Bethlehem and all of Israel. But this blessing goes even deeper because they specifically connect Boaz to Perez — the breakthrough son of Judah. Perez had become one of the leading family lines within the tribe of Judah, carrying the covenant seed promise forward through generations. By linking Boaz to Perez, the people were prophetically recognizing that Boaz carried the Messianic seed line within his family. This was far bigger than a marriage blessing; it was a prophetic announcement that redemption, kingship, and ultimately Messiah would come through this lineage. What looked like a simple moment at the city gate was actually Heaven declaring the future. Through Boaz and Ruth would come David, and through David would come Jesus Christ — the Redeemer of the world.

BREAKING THE TEN-GENERATION CURSE

Deuteronomy 23:3

Ruth 4:18–22

Ruth Breaking the Moabite Curse — Redemption Greater Than the Law

One of the most fascinating prophetic dimensions in the Book of Ruth is that Ruth appears to overcome the restriction found in Book of Deuteronomy 23:3:

“No Ammonite or Moabite may enter the assembly of the Lord... even to the tenth generation.”
— Deuteronomy 23:3

This raises a major theological question:

How could Ruth — a Moabite woman — become the great-grandmother of King David and ultimately be inserted into the Messianic lineage of Jesus Christ?

1. The Curse of Deuteronomy 23:3

The restriction against Moabites existed because the Moabites refused to help Israel during the Exodus and because they hired Balaam to curse Israel.

“Because they met you not with bread and with water in the way, when ye came forth out of Egypt; and because they hired against thee Balaam...”
— Deuteronomy 23:4

The genealogy in Ruth intentionally lists ten generations from Perez to David.

This becomes a prophetic statement:
redemption is greater than exclusion.

By the tenth generation:
David stands as proof that grace rewrites bloodlines.

the genealogy at the **7th generation from Perez**, and David becomes the **10th generation**.
([Bible Gateway](#))

Why This Matters Prophetically

This becomes incredibly significant when connected to Book of Deuteronomy 23:2–3:

“A bastard shall not enter into the congregation of the Lord; even to his tenth generation...”
“An Ammonite or Moabite shall not enter into the congregation of the Lord; even to their tenth generation...”

Many Hebraic teachers and commentators believe the genealogy at the end of Ruth was intentionally arranged to show that:

- **the curse and exclusion had reached its completion,**
- and grace had fully brought restoration by the time of David. ([Michael Craft](#))

This is one reason the genealogy is included at the end of Ruth instead of ending simply with Boaz and Ruth’s marriage.

The genealogy itself is preaching.

A Powerful Teaching Insight

Perez himself was born from the scandal involving Judah and Tamar in Book of Genesis 38. His birth carried the stigma of illegitimacy in Jewish interpretation.

Yet from Perez comes:

- Boaz,
- David,
- and eventually Jesus Christ.

This means:

- Tamar's scandal,
- Ruth's Moabite curse,
- David's questioned legitimacy,
- all become swallowed up in redemption.

God intentionally builds the Messianic line through broken, excluded, and unlikely people to demonstrate that grace is greater than shame.

What the Law excluded, redemption restored.

And by the tenth generation, David — Israel's greatest king — stands as proof that God can redeem an entire bloodline.

PEREZ — BREAKTHROUGH

Genesis 38

Perez was born through the scandal involving Judah and Tamar.

His name means:

- breach,
- breakthrough,
- bursting forth.

What looked shameful became sacred in redemption history.

God intentionally brought Messiah through broken lines to demonstrate: grace is greater than failure.

THE MYSTERY OF TOLEDOT

Genesis 2:4

Genesis 5:1

Ruth 4:18

The Hebrew word for “generations” is:

Toledot

In Genesis 2:4, before the Fall, the word is fully spelled.

The first mention is in Genesis 2:4 The picture graph of this Hebrew word spells out the following meaning...

TAV... covenant
VAV... nail
DALET... Shepherd
LAMED... door
VAV... nail
TAV... covenant

In Genesis 2:24 both VAV are in the word generations of heaven and earth...
After sin enters, the spelling becomes defective — missing the Hebrew letter “Vav.”

The missing Vav symbolizes:

- brokenness,
- loss,
- fractured generations.

But in Ruth 4:
the full spelling returns.

Why?

Because redemption is entering the story.

The restored generations point toward:

- David,
- and ultimately Jesus Christ.

“The covenant secured through the nailed Shepherd who becomes the Door.”

JESUS — THE TRUE BOAZ

Boaz is not merely a good man.

He is a prophetic picture of Jesus:

- redeemer,
- provider,
- bridegroom,
- covenant keeper.

Ruth entered the field as an outsider.

She left as part of the royal bloodline.

That is the Gospel.

We were:

- strangers,
- outsiders,
- without inheritance,
- without hope.

But Jesus:

- noticed us,
- redeemed us,
- covered us,
- and brought us into His house.

THE END-TIMES PROPHETIC PICTURE

The Book of Ruth is also prophetic.

A Gentile bride is redeemed before Naomi is restored.

This mirrors:

- the Church being gathered,
- before Israel's full restoration.

The entire story becomes a prophetic rehearsal of:

- redemption,
- resurrection,
- harvest,
- and Messiah.

FINAL APPLICATION

1. God Works Through Brokenness

Perez.
Tamar.
Ruth.
David.

God specializes in rewriting broken stories.

2. Covenant Requires Clinging

Orpah kissed.
Ruth clung.

Temporary affection is not covenant commitment.

3. Grace Is Greater Than Law

The Law identified the problem.
Grace redeemed the bride.

4. Jesus Is Our Kinsman Redeemer

He fulfilled every legal requirement necessary to redeem humanity.

CONCLUSION

The Book of Ruth begins with:

- famine,
- bitterness,
- loss,
- death.

But it ends with:

- harvest,
- covenant,
- redemption,
- Messiah.

What began in famine ends in fullness.

What began with graves ends with genealogy.

What began with bitterness ends with blessing.

Ruth entered the field as a foreigner.

She left as part of the lineage of Jesus Christ.

That is the Gospel.

“Where sin abounded, grace did much more abound.” — Romans 5:20

“For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ shall all be made alive.” — 1 Corinthians 15:22